

Qi Zhao

Baltimore, Maryland, United States

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EDUCATION

University of Maryland, Baltimore County, Baltimore, United States

August 2025 – May 2030(exp)

Ph.D. of Human-Centered Computing

Indiana University Indianapolis, Indianapolis, United States

August 2023 – May 2025

Master of Science in Human Computer Interaction

GPA: 3.96/4.00

Thesis Title: Understanding Post-retirement Workers in the Gig Economy as Online Personal Shoppers: Motivations, Expectations and Technology-related Challenges

Hang Zhou Dianzi University, Hangzhou, China

September 2019 – July 2023

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Technology

GPA: 4.27/5.00

Thesis: Design and Implementation of a Continuous Integration and Deployment Platform Based on Docker Compose

PUBLICATIONS

1. Yuwen Lu, Meng Chen, **Qi Zhao**, Victor Cox, Yang Yang, Meng Jiang, Jay Brockman, Tamara Kay, and Toby Jia-Jun Li. 2026. Crepe: A Mobile Screen Data Collector Using Graph Query. In Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26), April 13– 17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 20 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791137>
2. **Qi Zhao** and Aqueasha Martin-Hammond. 2026. "I don't feel lonely because I don't work alone most of the time": Exploring Gig Work as an Opportunity for Social Participation Among Older Adults. In Extended Abstracts of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '26), April 13–17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 6 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772363.3798370>

EXPERIENCE

Space for All - Building Accessible Makerspaces with and for Youth and Young Adults with Autism in Baltimore City

Indianapolis, United States

Graduate Research Assistant

January 2026 – Present

- Attended Black SONs and Rec-to-Tech event in Baltimore area to build relationship with local organizations; Learned how 3D printing objects worked in accessibility context
- Analyzed focus group and panel discussion transcripts and coded themes;
- Wrote reflection report regarding research methods;

Bizchat: An AI-Powered Tool for Business Plan Writing

Baltimore, United States

Graduate Research Assistant

August 2025 – Present

- Presented Bizchat at one million cup at Oca Mocha; Attended Hack Day at school of business in Howard University and one million cups to pitch project and Q&A with real target users; Attended BlackSONs and Rec-to-Tech to showcase Bizchat; Attended SMBA&D 2026 WBE townhall fireside chat hosted by Baltimore mayor's office.
- Developed core features and Maintain existing code bases using React.js and Typescript.
- Developed New AI Literacy features that help entrepreneurs evaluate AI generated business plans and selecting different AI Models to support privacy considerations.
- Designed pre- and post- survey and conducted two workshops in low-income community called HACA in Annapolis to deploy the new features .

Exploring Older Adults' Experiences of Participating in Gig Work as Online Personal Shoppers after Retirement

Indianapolis, United States

Graduate Research Assistant

August 2024 – March 2026

- Conducted 29 semi-structured interviews with retired older adults regarding their experiences of working as online personal shoppers; Cleaned and coded transcripts using Code book.
- Submitted one poster paper to CHI 2026 and got accepted.

Internship

Hikvision

Hangzhou, China

Front-end Developer

April 2022 - August 2022

- Completed 30+ tasks and fixed 60+ bugs; worked with a UX designer to implement the new design prototypes of different test platforms; implemented front-end pages with interactable components using HTML, JavaScript and CSS.
- Developed new features for an inner UI automation test platform, including one that allowed test developers to create test scripts based on their mouse actions; reduced time for test developers to write test cases by 20%, which was praised by my mentor and test developers.